

1 ADJECTIVES

- a Complete the sentences with an adjective from the list.

bright /braɪt/ conscientious /ˌkɒnʃiˈenʃəs/
determined /drɪˈtɜːmɪnd/ gentle /ˈdʒentl/
resourceful /rɪˈsɔːsfl/ sarcastic /sɑːˈkæstɪk/
self-sufficient /ˌself-səˈfɪʃnt/
spontaneous /spɒnˈteɪniəs/ steady /ˈstedi/
straightforward /ˌstreɪtˈfɔːwəd/
sympathetic /ˌsɪmpəˈθetɪk/ thorough /ˈθʌrə/

- 1 He's quite resourceful. He can usually work out how to solve a problem.
- 2 He's very _____. Whatever part of a job he's doing, he does it with great attention to detail.
- 3 My nieces are both really _____. They get very good marks at school in all their subjects.
- 4 She's such a _____ person. She's honest and open and says just what she thinks.
- 5 She's very _____. Once she's decided to do something, nothing will stop her.
- 6 He's very _____. He never needs anyone else's help.
- 7 He's not very _____. When I was ill last week, he didn't even phone me.
- 8 She is so _____! She worked all weekend to make sure she got everything done.
- 9 My sister's a very _____ person. She's calm and kind and she never gets angry.
- 10 Her boyfriend is a _____ kind of guy. He's sensible and she can really rely on him.
- 11 He's very _____. He can suddenly decide to go to Paris in the morning and in the evening he's there!
- 12 Our maths teacher used to be so _____. She loved making comments that made us feel small.

- b 1.5 Listen and check.

False friends

Be careful with *sympathetic*. Many languages have a similar adjective – *sympathique* (French), *simpatico* (Italian), *sympatyczny* (Polish), *sempatik* (Turkish) – which means *friendly, nice*. The same is true of *gentle*; this is not the same as, e.g. *gentil* (French), *gentile* (Italian), which mean *kind* or *polite*.

2 USEFUL PHRASES WHEN DESCRIBING PERSONALITY

- a Complete the sentences with a phrase from the list.

a bit of a a bit too comes across deep down on the surface
on the whole tends to

- 1 My father tends to avoid conflict – he never argues with my mother, he just leaves the room.
- 2 _____ he seems self-confident, but _____ he's quite insecure.
- 3 I worry about my grandmother. She's _____ trusting, so it's easy for people to take advantage of her.
- 4 _____ he's pretty laid-back, though he can sometimes get very stressed about work.
- 5 She's _____ control freak – she always needs to organize everything and everybody.
- 6 He _____ as quite sarcastic, but in fact he's really friendly.

- b 1.6 Listen and check.

3 IDIOMS

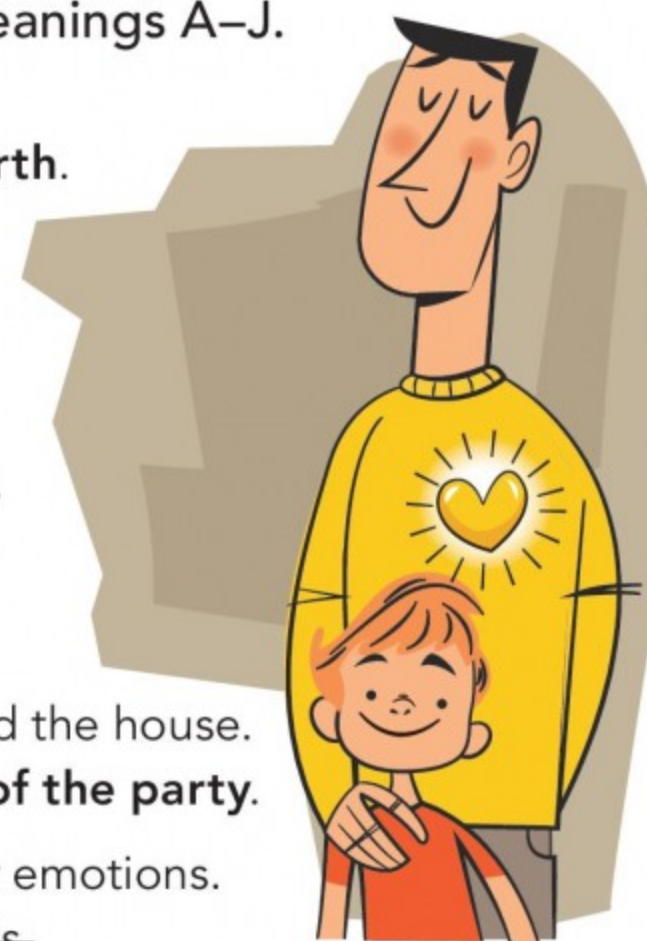
- a Match the **bold** idioms 1–10 to their meanings A–J.

- 1 ☒ B My dad's got **a heart of gold**.
- 2 ☐ My brother-in-law is very **down to earth**.
- 3 ☐ My boss is a bit of **a cold fish**.
- 4 ☐ My brother's **a real pain in the neck**.
- 5 ☐ My mum's **a soft touch**.
- 6 ☐ My uncle has **a very quick temper**.
- 7 ☐ I know I shouldn't criticise your family, but your sister is really **full of herself**.
- 8 ☐ He comes across as aggressive, but in fact he **wouldn't hurt a fly**.
- 9 ☐ My brother never **lifts a finger** around the house.
- 10 ☐ My cousin's always **the life and soul of the party**.

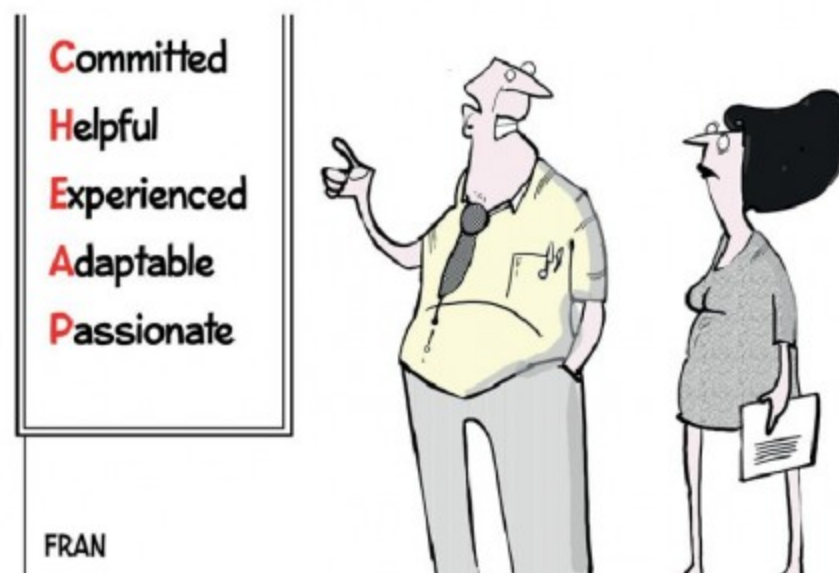
- A She's unfriendly and she never shows her emotions.
B ~~He's incredibly kind to everyone he meets.~~
C He's so annoying – he's always taking my things.
D She's great at telling jokes and making people laugh.
E I can always persuade her to give me extra pocket money.
F He expects the rest of us to do everything.
G He's the gentlest person I know.
H He gets angry very easily.
I He's very sensible and practical.
J She thinks she's the most important member of the family.

- b 1.7 Listen and check.

ACTIVATION Think of people you know for two adjectives from **1**, a phrase from **2**, and an idiom from **3**. Tell your partner about them and why they suit the description.



1 ADJECTIVES



"So when it come to selecting STAFF these are the qualities I'm looking for."

a Match sentences 1–8 to A–H.

- 1 **C** My job as a divorce lawyer is very **challenging** /'tʃælɪndʒɪŋ/.
- 2 **E** Working as a checkout assistant can be a bit **monotonous** /mə'nɒtənəs/ and **repetitive** /rɪ'petətɪv/.
- 3 **F** I'm a primary school teacher. I find working with children very **rewarding** /rɪ'wɔːdɪŋ/ (**fulfilling** /fʊl'fɪlɪŋ/).
- 4 **G** I work in a small design company and my job's really **motivating** /'məʊtɪveɪtɪŋ/.
- 5 **D** Being a surgeon is very **demanding** /dr'mɑːndɪŋ/.
- 6 **A** I always wanted an exciting job, but sadly, mine is incredibly **tedious** /'tiːdiəs/.
- 7 **H** He's in a **dead-end** /'ded end/ job in the local factory.
- 8 **B** She's got a very **high-powered** /haɪ 'paʊəd/ job in finance.

- A I have to do exactly the same thing every day.
- B I never mind having to work overtime.
- C It tests my abilities in a way that keeps me interested.
- D It's important and comes with a lot of responsibility.
- E It's really boring and it makes me feel impatient all the time.
- F It makes me happy because it's useful and important.
- G The wages are low and there's no hope of promotion.
- H It's very high pressure and you have to work long hours.

b 1.10 Listen and check.

ACTIVATION Think of a job you could describe with each adjective in 1.

2 COLLOCATIONS

a Complete the sentences with a word from A and a word from B.

A academic career (x2) civil events fast job work	B experience hunting ladder manager move qualifications servants track
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- 1 I'm hoping it'll be a good career move to go from publishing to advertising.
- 2 I've been unemployed for six months now, so I spend most of my time _____.
- 3 My brother works as an _____, organizing conferences.
- 4 I left school at 15, so I had to look for a job that didn't require any _____.
- 5 My problem is that all the jobs I want to apply for ask for some _____, and as I've just finished university, I don't have any.
- 6 I'm a junior doctor, and if I want to move up the _____, I need to work in several different hospitals and departments.
- 7 In Britain, people who work for government departments are called _____.
- 8 In some careers, people with very good qualifications are put onto a _____ so they get promoted more quickly.

b 1.11 Listen and check.

c Complete the two words which collocate with the groups below. What do the phrases mean?

maternity paternity sick compassionate unpaid	I _____	freelance permanent (opp temporary /fixed-term) full-time (opp part-time) zero-hours	c _____
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3 THE SAME OR DIFFERENT?

a Look at the **bold** pairs of words or phrases. Write **S** if they have the same or a very similar meaning and **D** if they are different. If the meaning is different, what's the difference? If the meaning is the same, is there a difference in register?

- 1 **S** I get on very well with my **colleagues** / **co-workers**.
- 2 **D** I've had enough of my job. I think I'm going to **quit** / **resign**.
- 3 **D** Three-quarters of the **staff** / **workforce** are women.
- 4 **D** 400 workers have been **laid off** / **made redundant**.
- 5 **D** He's been **out of work** / **off work** for nearly six months.
- 6 **D** She **was sacked** / **was fired** for refusing to work on Sundays.
- 7 **D** Fantastic news! I'm going to **get promoted** / **get a pay rise**!
- 8 **D** What **skills** / **qualifications** do you have?
- 9 **D** We're too busy – we need to **hire** / **employ** more staff.
- 10 **D** The salary's a bit low, but we have some great **perks** / **benefits**.

b 1.12 Listen and check.

1 EXPRESSIONS WITH GET

a Complete the sentences with an expression from the list.

hold of into trouble with out of the way
(my / your, etc.) own back on rid of the chance ~~the impression~~
the joke the wrong end of the stick to know

- 1 I **get** the impression you're a bit annoyed with me.
- 2 When I told him to meet us at the station, he **got** _____ and went to the bus station, not the train station.
- 3 Since we stopped working together, we hardly ever **get** _____ to see each other.
- 4 Everyone else laughed, but I didn't **get** _____.
- 5 When you **get** _____ him, I think you'll really like him.
- 6 I need to speak to Martina urgently, but I just can't **get** _____ her.
- 7 I want to **get** _____ that awful painting, but I can't because it was a wedding present from my mother-in-law.
- 8 I'm going to **get** _____ my brother for telling our parents I got home late. Now I won't lend him my bike.
- 9 He's going to **get** _____ his boss if he's late again.
- 10 I tried to walk past him, but he wouldn't **get** _____.

b 3.7 Listen and check. What do the expressions mean? Explain them in your own words.

2 IDIOMS WITH GET

a Match sentences 1–10 to A–J.

- 1 **Get real!**
 - 2 **Get a life!**
 - 3 I'm **not getting anywhere** with this crossword.
 - 4 She really **gets on my nerves**.
 - 5 She really needs to **get her act together**.
 - 6 They **get on like a house on fire**.
 - 7 You should **get a move on**.
 - 8 Your grandfather must be **getting on** a bit.
 - 9 My boss just never **gets the message**.
 - 10 She always **gets her own way**.
- A It's just too difficult for me.
B Is he in his eighties now?
C They have exactly the same tastes and interests.
D Her exam is in two weeks and she hasn't even started studying.
E If you don't leave soon, you'll miss the train.
F Everything about her irritates me, her voice, her smile – everything!
G Everyone just does whatever she tells them to.
H I keep dropping hints about a pay rise, but he takes no notice.
I ~~There's no way you can afford that car!~~
J You're 40 and you're still living with your parents!

b 3.8 Listen and check. What do the idioms mean? Explain them in your own words.

3 PHRASAL VERBS WITH GET

a Match the **bold** phrasal verbs to A–L.

- 1 **J** How did you and your boyfriend **get together**?
- 2 It can take a long time to **get over** a break-up.
- 3 I hate being interrupted when I'm trying to **get on with** my work.
- 4 We keep telling our teenage son how important it is to study hard, but it's impossible to **get through to** him.
- 5 She's studying economics at university, and then she wants to **get into** banking.
- 6 What's the best way to **get around** your city, on foot or by public transport?
- 7 Don't try to cheat in the exam, you'll never **get away with** it.
- 8 They have just enough money to **get by**, but they have to watch every penny.
- 9 I need to work this weekend because I **got behind** during the week.
- 10 The weather here is terrible in winter, it really **gets me down**.
- 11 I promised I'd help Matt move house, but I **got out of** it by saying I had a bad back.
- 12 Please leave a message and I'll **get back to** you as soon as I can.

- A recover from
B start a career or profession
C move from place to place
D make sb understand
E manage with what you have
F fail to make enough progress
G make sb feel depressed
H respond to sb by speaking or writing
I avoid a responsibility or obligation
J ~~start a relationship~~
K continue doing
L do sth wrong without getting caught

b 3.9 Listen and check.

ACTIVATION Look at A–L in a and remember the phrasal verbs.

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1 PEOPLE AND EVENTS

a Match the people and definitions.

ally /'ælaɪ/ casualties /'kæʒuəltɪz/
 civilians /sə'vɪliənz/ commander /kə'mændə/
 forces /'fɔːsɪz/ refugees /ˌrefjuːdʒiːz/
 snipers /'snaɪpəz/ survivors /sə'vaɪvəz/
 troops /truːps/ the wounded /'wuːndɪd/

- 1 casualties = people who have been killed or injured in a war
- 2 _____ = people who are forced to leave their country or home because there is a war, or for political or religious reasons
- 3 _____ = a group of people who have been trained to protect others, usually with weapons, e.g. *armed ~, security ~, peace-keeping ~*.
- 4 _____ = soldiers in large groups
- 5 _____ = an officer in charge of a military operation
- 6 _____ = people who have been injured by weapons
- 7 _____ = people who are not in the army, navy, or airforce
- 8 _____ = people who shoot at others from a hidden position
- 9 _____ = people who have managed to stay alive in a war
- 10 _____ = in time of war, a country that has agreed to help and support another country

b Match the events and definitions.

ceasefire /'siːsfɑː/ civil war /ˌsɪvəl 'wɔː/
 coup /kuː/ rebellion /rɪ'beljən/
revolution /ˌrevə'lʊʃn/ siege /sɪdʒ/ treaty /'triːti/

- 1 rebellion = an attempt by some of the people in a country to change their government, using violence
- 2 _____ = a sudden change of government that is illegal and often violent
- 3 _____ = when two armies agree to stop fighting temporarily
- 4 _____ = when an army tries to take a city or building by surrounding it and stopping the food supply
- 5 _____ = a war between groups of people in the same country
- 6 _____ = a formal agreement between two or more countries.
- 7 _____ = an attempt by a large number of people in a country to change their government

c  **3.10** Listen and check your answers to a and b.



2 CONFLICT VERBS

a Complete the sentences with a verb from the list in the correct form.

blow up break out capture declare defeat execute
 loot overthrow release retreat shell surrender

- 1 The rebels overthrew the government. (= removed them from power using force)
- 2 Fighting _____ between the rebels and the army. (= started)
- 3 The army _____ the rebel positions. (= fired missiles at)
- 4 The rebels _____. (= moved back, away from the army)
- 5 Some of the rebels _____. (= admitted they had lost and wanted to stop fighting)
- 6 The rebels _____ the airport runway. (= made it explode)
- 7 The government _____ war on the rebels. (= announced their intention to go to war with them)
- 8 Some rebels _____ the city. (= stole things from shops and buildings)
- 9 The army _____ over 300 rebels. (= took them prisoner)
- 10 They finally _____ the rebels. (= beat them)
- 11 The army _____ most of the rebel prisoners. (= let them go)
- 12 They _____ the rebel leader. (= killed him as a punishment)

b  **3.11** Listen and check.

3 METAPHORICAL USES OF 'CONFLICT VERBS'

a Complete the sentences with a verb from 2 in the correct form.

- 1 The fire broke out at 3.00 in the morning.
- 2 The police have _____ details of the accident.
- 3 The new princess has _____ the imagination of the public.
- 4 I read the instructions three times, but they completely _____ me.
- 5 The minister was arrested and forced to _____ his passport.
- 6 A crisis has _____ over the new education policy.
- 7 He _____ that he was in love with her.
- 8 The flood water took a long time to _____ from the streets.

b  **3.12** Listen and check.

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1 SOUNDS

- a  **4.7** All the words from the list can be both nouns and regular verbs. Many of them are onomatopoeic (they sound like the sound they describe). Listen to the sounds and the words.



bang /bæŋ/ buzz /bʌz/ click /kɪk/ crash /kræʃ/
creak /kriːk/ crunch /krʌntʃ/ drip /drɪp/ hiss /hɪs/
hoot /huːt/ hum /hʌm/ rattle /ˈrætəl/ roar /rɔː/ screech /skriːtʃ/
slam /slæm/ slurp /slɜːp/ sniff /snɪf/ snore /snɔː/ splash /splæʃ/
tap /tæp/ tick /tɪk/ whistle /ˈwɪsl/

- b Complete the **Sounds** column with the words from the list in a.

- 1 This clock has a very loud .
- 2 Don't ! Get a tissue and blow your nose.
- 3 To get the new software, just on the 'download' icon.
- 4 There was a as he jumped into the swimming pool.
- 5 Did you hear that ? It sounded like a gun.
- 6 I heard a floorboard and I knew somebody had come into the room.
- 7 I could hear the of a fly, but I couldn't see it anywhere.
- 8 I hate people who at me when I slow down at an amber light.
- 9 When I'm nervous, I often my fingers on the table.
- 10 Don't your soup! Eat it quietly.
- 11 The snake reared its head and gave an angry .
- 12 Please turn the tap off properly, otherwise it'll .
- 13 We could hear the of the crowd in the football stadium from our hotel.
- 14 Some of the players carried on playing because they hadn't heard the .
- 15 I don't remember the words of the song, but I can the tune.
- 16 Please don't the door. Close it gently.
- 17 I heard the of their feet walking through the crisp snow.
- 18 I can't share a room with you if you – I won't be able to sleep.
- 19 Every time a bus or lorry goes by, the windows .
- 20 I heard the of brakes as the driver tried to stop and then a loud .

Sounds

tick



2 THE HUMAN VOICE

- a Match the verbs and definitions.

giggle /ˈɡɪɡl/ groan /ɡrəʊn/
mumble /ˈmʌmbl/ scream /skriːm/
sigh /saɪ/ sob /sɒb/ stammer /ˈstæmə/
whisper /ˈwɪspə/ yell /jel/

- 1 scream = to make a loud, high cry because you are hurt, frightened, or excited
- 2 _____ (at sb) = to shout loudly, e.g. because you are angry
- 3 _____ (at sth) = to laugh in a silly way
- 4 _____ (to sb) = to speak very quietly, so that other people can't hear what you're saying
- 5 _____ = to speak or say sth in a quiet voice in a way that is not clear
- 6 _____ = to make a long deep sound because you are in pain or annoyed
- 7 _____ = (or stutter) to speak with difficulty, often repeating sounds or words
- 8 _____ = to cry noisily, taking sudden sharp breaths
- 9 _____ = to let out a long deep breath, e.g. to show that you are disappointed or tired

- b  **4.9** Listen and check.

- c Answer the questions using one of the verbs in a.

What do people do...?

- when they are nervous
- when they are terrified
- when they lose their temper
- when they are not supposed to be making any noise
- when they are amused or embarrassed
- when they speak without opening their mouth enough
- when they are relieved
- when their team misses a penalty
- when they are very unhappy about something

ACTIVATION Choose five sounds from 1 and two verbs from 2. Make the sounds for your partner to identify.

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- c  **4.8** Listen and check.

